

Salesforce Q2 2026 Earnings

Blind Sentiment & Directional Score: Financial results only

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Conventions (sealed before reading)

- **Outputs (exactly four):** sentiment score $\in [-1, +1]$, directional signal $\in \{\text{BUY, HOLD, SELL}\}$, structured summary, evidence quotes.
- **HOLD band:** $|\text{overnight move}| < 2.00\%$. Above $+2.00\%$, BUY is correct. Below -2.00% , SELL is correct.
- **Timing rule:** The company releases after the market close. The overnight move is defined as $(\text{next-trading-day Open} \div \text{release-day Close}) - 1$, applied identically to every report.
- **Price source:** Yahoo Finance daily OHLC pulled via the `yfinance` Python library.
- **Info-source experiment:** this read uses **Financial results only** as the ONLY report content. The other sections (forward guidance, the earnings call Q&A) are withheld by design. Sources rotate across companies, so each company reads each source exactly once and each quarter slot contains two of each source.
- **Research:** Google is allowed for pre-release context (definitions, prior-quarter framing, analyst expectations going into the print). Not allowed before sealing: the withheld sections, the stock's price action after the release, after-hours quotes, or post-call analyst takes.
- **Pre-registered metrics:** the primary metric is the Information Coefficient (correlation between the sentiment score and the realised move); the BUY/HOLD/SELL labels are additionally scored with the Matthews Correlation Coefficient (MCC), where guessing the most common label scores zero. Both fixed in advance; no new metrics after seeing results.
- **Horizons:** returns are recorded at overnight, 1, 3, 5, 10 and 20 trading days to locate where the signal lives. The $\pm 2.00\%$ band applies to the overnight move only.

Report metadata

Company	Salesforce, Inc. (CRM)
Report	Fiscal Q2 2026 (July quarter)
Release date	Wednesday 3 September 2025, after close
Earnings call	5:00pm ET
Source	Earnings press release
Read mode	cold; reported financial results only, no guidance, no Q&A, no price chart
Time to produce	33 minutes

Source material (read ONLY this)

Headline financials (assigned source: financial results only)

- Revenue \$10.2B, up 10% year over year and 9% in constant currency. Subscription and support revenue \$9.7B, up 11% (9% in constant currency).
- Current remaining performance obligation \$29.4B, up 11% year over year and 10% in constant currency.
- GAAP operating margin 22.8%; non-GAAP operating margin 34.3%.

- Returned \$2.6B to shareholders in the quarter: \$2.2B of share repurchases and \$399M of dividends.
- Share repurchase authorisation increased by \$20B to \$50B in total. Management described the company as on track for a record fiscal 2026 with nearly \$15B of operating cash flow.

Your scoring: fill in below, then seal

1 Sentiment score

Score: +0.45

Rationale. Double-digit revenue and subscription growth, an 11% cRPO build, a 34.3% non-GAAP margin and a \$20B buyback increase: broad execution with capital returns on top.

2 Directional signal

Signal: BUY

Rationale. Growth holding at 10% with margin expansion and a bigger buyback is a clean print. BUY.

3 Structured summary

- **What the source shows.** Revenue, cRPO and margin all moved the right way, with a larger buyback attached.
- **What the source cannot show.** No guide, and for this name the forward number usually decides the reaction.
- **Expectations bar.** Ten percent growth is respectable but close to the run rate already assumed.
- **Conviction.** Moderate conviction: the print is solid, though nothing here is a step change.

4 Evidence quotes

1. Revenue \$10.2B, up 10% year over year and 9% in constant currency. Subscription and support revenue \$9.7B, up 11% (9% in constant currency).
2. Current remaining performance obligation \$29.4B, up 11% year over year and 10% in constant currency.
3. GAAP operating margin 22.8%; non-GAAP operating margin 34.3%.

— **SEALED** —

Overnight move and call verification

CRM close, 3 September 2025 (release day)	\$256.45
CRM open, 4 September 2025	\$240.06
Overnight move	−6.39%

Call verification

- HOLD band test: $|-6.39\%| \geq 2.00\%$, so this is not a HOLD.
- Sign test: The move is negative, so the correct directional call is **SELL**.
- Score given vs. correct call: signal was **BUY**, correct call **SELL**, so **INCORRECT**.

Horizon returns (pre-registered)

For the Information Coefficient. Returns measured from the same baseline close used for the overnight move, at fixed trading-day horizons, from the single price source (yfinance). Filled only after sealing.

Horizon	Return
Overnight (baseline for the label)	− 6.39%
D+1 close	−4.85%
D+3 close	−1.63%
D+5 close	−5.41%
D+10 close	−5.55%
D+20 close	−8.10%